LOTUS TECHNOLOGIES (PVT) LTD · ASIA BROADCASTING CORPORATION

HiruNews AI Streamline

AI-Powered End-to-End Broadcast News Production

SLASSCOM NATIONAL INGENUITY AWARDS 2026 · BEST TECH FOR GOOD SOFTWARE INNOVATION

> "From raw press release to broadcast-ready Sinhala tagline — in minutes, not hours."

FOUNDED & DEVELOPED BY

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SUBMITTING ORGANISATION

Lotus Technologies (Pvt) Ltd
under Asia Broadcasting Corporation (Pvt) Ltd

PRODUCTION STATUS

Live at Hiru News since August 2025
Sri Lanka's #1 Television News Broadcast

PROVEN IN CRISIS

Ditwa Cyclone response, November–December 2025 — emergency bulletins broadcast faster than all competing channels

asiabroadcasting.lk hirunews.lk hirutv.lk

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THE CHALLENGE & THE SOLUTION

BEFORE

- ✕ 35+ staff coordinated per bulletin
- ✕ 8 dedicated graphics team members
- ✕ Manual audio listening & transcription
- ✕ Manual Sinhala tagline drafting
- ✕ Multiple news-desk ↔ graphics roundtrips
- ✕ Separate PNG creation per tagline
- ✕ Slow emergency broadcast response
- ✕ Error-prone at every manual handoff

HIRUNEWS AI STREAMLINE

- ✓ AI ingests audio, video & press releases
- ✓ Auto-generates Sinhala taglines & subtitles
- ✓ Senior editor reviews & approves every item
- ✓ Single news team member operates full pipeline
- ✓ HiruTaglineCreator renders PNGs on-device
- ✓ Zero graphics team roundtrip required
- ✓ Human-in-the-loop at every stage
- ✓ Battle-tested: Ditwa Cyclone (Nov–Dec 2025)

~68%
OVERALL TIME REDUCED

~45%
COST REDUCTION

30+ min
SAVED PER BULLETIN

END-TO-END WORKFLOW — ONE UNIFIED PIPELINE

Raw Material Intake › AI Ingestion & Generation › Editor Review & Approval › HiruTaglineCreator PNG Render › Live Broadcast

• Live since August 2025 · 3 bulletins/day · up to 80 taglines/bulletin

AI News Ingestion

Ingests raw press releases, audio recordings, and video packages. Layered AI stack — Gemini Pro, OpenAI, and a local LLM prototype — processes content and queues it for editorial review.

Speaker-Diarized Subtitles

Speech-to-text with multi-speaker identification separates voices in press conferences and interviews, generating attributed, formatted Sinhala transcripts automatically.

Editorial Approval Workflow

Every AI output passes a mandatory senior journalist review gate. No content reaches broadcast without human approval — editorial integrity is structurally enforced, not optional.

HiruTaglineCreator v2.1

Production PyQt5 desktop app rendering broadcast-ready 1920×1080 transparent PNG overlays. Dual MAIN TAG / SUB TAG templates. On-device rendering — no cloud dependency at the broadcast step.

Sinhala Typography Pipeline

762-line deterministic converter: Singlish → Sinhala Unicode → FM ASCII. Handles rakaransaya, yansaya, ්‍ conjuncts, "ද්‍රව්‍ය" word exceptions, Latin PUA — pixel-perfect via HarfBuzz shaping.

Session-Based Bulletin Workflow

Session management aligned to Hiru News's three-bulletin daily cadence (11:55 AM · 6:55 PM · 9:55 PM). Handles ~20 segments and up to 80 taglines per bulletin within a single session.

TECH STACK

PyQt5 · Pillow · HarfBuzz · Gemini Pro · OpenAI API · Local LLM · Speech-to-Text · Speaker Diarization · PyInstaller · Claude Code

RESPONSIBLE AI

Human-in-the-Loop · PII Protected · Confidential Sources Safeguarded · No Automated Publishing · Editorial Standards Maintained · No Fake News Pipeline

Engineering depth: 24 documented engineering challenges resolved across 8 iterative development stages — from Pillow bitmap rendering failures to PyInstaller Qt plugin packaging, FM-font diacritic edge cases, and complex Sinhala conjunct handling.

TECH FOR GOOD — PROVEN IMPACT

Faster Disaster Alerts — Real-World Proven

During the Ditwa Cyclone (Nov–Dec 2025), Hiru News used the live system to broadcast evacuation orders, government directives, and safety warnings faster than all competing channels — during a real national emergency, while the system was in full production.

Sinhala-Language Dignity

Serves millions of rural, elderly, and lower-income Sri Lankans who rely on Sinhala TV as their primary — often only — source of news and public safety information. Every efficiency gain reaches this audience directly.

Trust-Critical Accuracy

Reduces transcription and formatting errors in public information broadcasting. AI generates; senior journalists approve. Combines AI speed with human editorial accuracy — no automation publishes directly.

Award-Recognised Humanitarian Mission

Golden Business Excellence Awards 2025: Outstanding Humanitarian Service — "Rata wenuwen hiru sahana yaathra." Formal validation that the platform delivering HiruNews AI Streamline's output is a documented community institution.

SELECTED AWARDS — HIRU NEWS (2023–2026)

2026	SLIM Kantar People's Awards — Most Popular News Provider
2026	Platinum Excellence Awards — Best News Brand
2026	Raigam Tele'es — Best Television News Broadcast
2025	Golden Business Excellence — Outstanding Humanitarian Service
2025	Golden Business Excellence — Most Influential Media Platform
2025	Diamond Awards — Most Popular News Channel
2025	Asia Miracle Awards — Most Popular News Channel
2024	SLIM Kantar People's Awards — Best TV News Provider
2024	Raigam Tele'es — Most Popular TV News Channel
2024	Business World International — Best TV News Provider
2023	Sumathi Awards — Best TV Investigative News Reporting
2023	Asia Miracle Awards — Most Popular News Channel & Brand

Full list: asiabroadcasting.lk/achievements.php

ROADMAP & WIDER ADOPTION

- → Tamil & English multilingual expansion (Sooriyan FM, Gold FM)
- → Full on-premise local LLM — source protection & offline resilience
- → Mobile editorial approval app for field assignments
- → Subscription licensing for regional broadcasters across South Asia
- → Direct broadcast playout integration (vMix / CasparCG)
- → Real-time live subtitle generation for accessibility

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